Community Involvement Opportunities

RetailzPOS / Vitreous Alliance · Patel Processing — Henry County, GA & Metro Atlanta · November 5, 2026 (Edition 5)

About this edition

This is the fifth edition of this recurring report (delivered every 4 days). This edition prioritized resolving the two longest-standing open questions from prior editions — the McDonough parade date and the Atlanta City Hall Diwali tradition's status. For the full standing list of leads not mentioned again below (because nothing has changed), see the October 22, October 25, October 29, and November 1 editions.

Resolved this edition

City of McDonough Christmas Parade & Tree Lighting is now confirmed: Saturday, December 5, 2026. Parade starts 6:00pm in Downtown McDonough. **Limited to the first 80 parade entries, with applications open now.** Tree-lighting time isn't confirmed yet, but the historical pattern (5pm lighting, 6pm parade) suggests the same evening. Source: City of McDonough newsflash/calendar. **This closes the single most-flagged unresolved lead across all four prior editions — and because entries are capped at 80, this is a "move now, not later" item if a parade entry is wanted.**

Atlanta City Hall Diwali — still unresolved, but a live lead surfaced. No article confirms a 2026 event has happened or has a set date. However, a CoHNA (Coalition of Hindus of North America) post on X reads "Atlanta City Hall is transformed with the spirit of Diwali! Ready to welcome Honorable Mayor Andre Dickens... Shubham Deepavali!" — phrased as a pre-event announcement, not a recap, suggesting an event may be imminent. The exact date couldn't be confirmed from search alone. **With Diwali itself landing Nov 7 this year, if this is genuinely new, the event is likely happening within days.** Worth checking x.com/CoHNAOfficial directly, since that's the one source this research couldn't fully resolve.

Other status updates

- **Kennesaw “Holiday Extravaganza”** — clarified: this is a **tree-decorating event**, not a lit display with city-provided power (participants get an unlit 6-ft tree + stake and decorate it themselves; lights allowed only if self-powered/solar). $25 individual registration. Nov 15, 2026 registration deadline confirmed — **10 days out.**
- **Stockbridge Holiday Festival** — the earlier Dec 5 vs. Dec 20 conflict partially clarifies: these appear to be **two different 2025 events**, not one rebranded — “Welcome to Grinchville” ran Dec 20 at VyStar Amphitheater, while a separate “Holiday Festival & Tree Lighting” ran Dec 5 at Tracey Wyatt Recreation Complex. No 2026 date for either yet — still needs direct city confirmation.
- **Marietta Square Merry Market** — still no 2026 date; 2025 was the 3rd annual, Dec 6.
- **Smyrna** — still no 2026 date; 2025’s Kris Kringle Market ran Dec 2 as part of “Home for the Holidays.”
- **Covington “Lighting of the Square”** — still no 2026 date; the pattern is a Thursday the week before Thanksgiving (2024 ran Nov 21), which would put **2026 around Nov 19 if the pattern holds — inference, not confirmed.**
- **Fayetteville “Miracle on Main Street”** — still no 2026 date; pattern is a Saturday in early-to-mid December.
- **Johns Creek Diwali Celebration** — reconfirmed: **Saturday, Nov 7, 2026, 2–7pm, The Boardwalk at Town Center.** Still the only fully confirmed Diwali-adjacent event in the metro area, and now just 2 days out.
- **Thanksgiving-week food drives** — no 2026-confirmed Henry County event found yet. All located precedents are from 2025 or undated; no 2026 sponsor-facing opportunity confirmed.

Scope note

Next edition should follow up directly on the CoHNA X post for the Diwali date, recheck Covington once Nov 19 passes to confirm/deny the inferred date, and recheck Smyrna, Fayetteville, Stockbridge, and Marietta Square Merry Market — all still lacking 2026 dates despite being well within their typical announcement windows.

This report recurs every 4 days. Each edition leads with status changes and new leads, and skips repeating anything unchanged from the prior edition.